MODULE 28 · EXAM STRATEGY - ALL DOMAINS

Practice exam 1 – twenty questions

Weighted 6/4/4/4/2 across the five domains, at exam pace.

DOMAIN All five WEIGHT 100% MODULE 28 of 31

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Before you start

- **Answer every question.** There is no penalty for a wrong answer, in this exam or the real one.
- **Write your answers down** as letters. Do not try to keep twenty of them in your head.
- **Note which shape caught you**, not just which fact. Module 27 named the six.
- Passing here is **15 or better**. Below 12 means go back to the domain the misses cluster in.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> The final two slides map every question to its domain and module, so a miss becomes a specific instruction.

> Every warehouse in an account is suspended. A user runs SELECT COUNT(*) FROM a 40 TB table and receives an answer in under a second, with no credits consumed.

What explains this?

A The query ran on the cloud services warehouse, which is always running.

B Snowflake auto-resumed a warehouse and suspended it again too quickly to bill.

C Row counts are held in micro-partition metadata in the cloud services layer, so no compute was needed.

D The result was served from the warehouse local disk cache.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What explains this?

A. A cloud services warehouse.
There is no such object. Cloud services is a layer, not a warehouse you can run queries on.

B. Auto-resume then suspend.
Any resume bills a 60-second minimum. Credits would have been consumed.

C. Row counts come from metadata.
The metadata cache answers COUNT(*) from micro-partition statistics without touching data or compute.

D. The warehouse local disk cache.
That cache lives on the warehouse and is dropped when it suspends. All warehouses are suspended.

ON THE EXAM

Modules 1 and 18. 'No credits consumed' is the decisive phrase: it rules out anything involving a warehouse.

> A company needs multi-cluster warehouses, materialized views, and 45 days of Time Travel. They do not handle PHI or payment card data, and do not need private connectivity.

What is the minimum edition?

A Enterprise

B Business Critical

C Standard

D Virtual Private Snowflake

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the minimum edition?

A Enterprise.

All three requirements land exactly on the Enterprise tier, and nothing named requires more.

B Business Critical.

Adds Tri-Secret Secure, PrivateLink and failover. The scenario explicitly rules out the triggers for those.

C Standard.

Standard has none of the three: no multi-cluster, no materialized views, and 1 day of Time Travel.

D VPS.

Dedicated hardware, and it loses Marketplace access. Vastly more than is needed.

ON THE EXAM

Module 2. The question asks for the minimum, so find the highest requirement and stop. All three sit on the same tier here.

> A developer creates a temporary table in a worksheet session, loads data into it, and asks a colleague to query it from their own session. The colleague reports the table does not exist.

Why?

A The colleague lacks SELECT on the table. Grant it and they will see it.

B Temporary tables must be created in a shared schema to be visible to others.

C The table is still being created. Temporary tables are asynchronous.

D A temporary table exists only within the session that created it and is not visible to any other session.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Why?

A Grant SELECT.

No grant makes a temporary table visible outside its session. It does not exist there to be granted on.

B Create it in a shared schema.

Schema choice is irrelevant. Session scope is a property of the table type.

C Still being created.

Invented. Table creation is synchronous.

D Session-scoped, invisible elsewhere.

That is the defining property of a temporary table, and it is dropped when the session ends.

ON THE EXAM

Module 4. Transient persists across sessions; temporary does not. That is the whole distinction between them.

> An architect needs Snowflake to run a query and return results from an AWS Lambda function. No driver may be installed in the Lambda runtime, and the team wants the least operational overhead.

Which interface fits?

A The Python connector, packaged as a Lambda layer.

B The SQL API, a REST interface requiring no driver.

C SnowSQL, invoked as a subprocess.

D The JDBC driver via a Java Lambda.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which interface fits?

A. Python connector as a layer.

Works, and it is a driver, which the scenario rules out. It also adds packaging overhead.

B. The SQL API.

A REST API with nothing to install, which is exactly why it suits serverless functions.

C. SnowSQL as a subprocess.

SnowSQL is an interactive client and is documented as legacy. Shelling out to it from Lambda is fragile.

D. JDBC via Java.

Still a driver, and it changes the runtime language to avoid a constraint that applies either way.

ON THE EXAM

Module 5. 'No driver' plus 'least operational overhead' is the SQL API's exact use case.

> A team wants to filter a table down to rows whose free-text feedback column expresses dissatisfaction, without writing a classifier or moving data out of Snowflake.

Which is the most direct approach?

A AI_FILTER in the WHERE clause, which returns true or false per row.

B Cortex Search, which retrieves the relevant rows.

C Cortex Analyst with a semantic model over the feedback column.

D Export the column and call an external sentiment API via an external function.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which is the most direct approach?

A AI_FILTER in WHERE.

Returns true or false and is usable in SELECT, WHERE and JOIN. An LLM becomes part of the query plan.

B Cortex Search.

Retrieval over unstructured documents. This is a column in a table, and the requirement is filtering rather than retrieval.

C Cortex Analyst.

Translates natural language into SQL over structured tables. It does not evaluate free text row by row.

D An external sentiment API.

Moves data out of Snowflake, which the scenario rules out, and adds an integration nobody asked for.

ON THE EXAM

Module 6. AI_SENTIMENT would also work. AI_FILTER is the one that puts the decision directly in the WHERE clause.

> A 5 TB table is queried almost exclusively with filters on an order_date column spanning a few days at a time. Query Profile shows partitions scanned close to partitions total.

What is the most appropriate action?

A Enable the Search Optimization Service on order_date.

B Increase the warehouse size so the scans complete faster.

C Create a materialized view filtered to the last 30 days.

D Define a clustering key on order_date.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most appropriate action?

A Search optimization on order_date.

Built for selective point lookups, substring and semi-structured predicates. These are range filters.

B A bigger warehouse.

Reads the same excess data faster and costs more. It does not improve pruning.

C A materialized view for 30 days.

Answers nothing outside that window, and the queries span arbitrary date ranges.

D A clustering key on order_date.

A date column with range filters on a large table is the textbook clustering case. It fixes the pruning directly.

ON THE EXAM

Modules 3 and 20. Ranges cluster; needles need the access path. That single distinction decides this question.

> A platform team must be able to create users and roles, and to grant privileges on objects they do not own. They must not be able to create warehouses or change account parameters.

Which role should they be granted?

A SYSADMIN

B SECURITYADMIN

C ACCOUNTADMIN

D USERADMIN

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which role should they be granted?

A SYSADMIN.

Creates warehouses and objects, which is explicitly forbidden, and cannot create users.

B SECURITYADMIN.

Holds MANAGE GRANTS and inherits USERADMIN, so it grants and creates users. It creates no warehouses and sets no account parameters.

C ACCOUNTADMIN.

Would work and grants far more than asked, including account parameters and billing. Never the minimum.

D USERADMIN.

Creates users and roles, and lacks MANAGE GRANTS, so it cannot grant on objects it does not own.

ON THE EXAM

Module 8. Two capabilities required and two forbidden. Only SECURITYADMIN satisfies all four constraints.

> An account-level network policy permits only the corporate range. A security integration used by a partner tool has its own network policy permitting the partner's addresses. A user with no user-level policy connects through that integration from a partner address.

What happens?

A The connection is blocked. The account policy always takes precedence.

B The connection is blocked. Both policies must permit the address.

C The connection is allowed. The security integration policy overrides the account policy.

D The connection is allowed only if the address also appears in the account policy's blocked list.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What happens?

A Blocked. Account takes precedence.

Inverts the order. The account policy is the most general and therefore the weakest.

B Blocked. Both must permit.

There is no intersection rule. Precedence selects one policy, and the others are not consulted.

C Allowed. The integration policy overrides the account.

Documented precedence: user beats security integration beats account. With no user policy, the integration policy applies.

D Allowed if also in the blocked list.

Nonsensical. The blocked list denies; it never permits.

ON THE EXAM

Module 9. Precedence runs user, then security integration, then account. The most specific applicable policy wins outright.

> Compliance requires that every column holding a national insurance number is masked identically across 300 tables in four databases, including tables created next month. The columns are named inconsistently.

What is the appropriate design?

A Classification to identify the columns, a tag applied by tag map, and a masking policy attached to the tag.

B A masking policy attached to each identified column, with a monthly review.

C A row access policy on each table, filtering out unauthorised roles.

D Secure views over all 300 tables, exposing a masked version of the column.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the appropriate design?

A Classify, tag, attach the policy to the tag.

Classification finds columns by content rather than name, and tag-based masking protects new columns as the tag lands.

B Per-column policy plus monthly review.

Leaves a month-long gap for new tables, and 300 attachments to maintain.

C Row access policies.

Wrong policy type. Row access filters rows; this requirement is about a column value.

D 300 secure views.

300 objects to build and keep in step with schema changes, and analysts lose the base tables.

ON THE EXAM

Module 10. 'Named inconsistently' rules out anything matching on column name, which is why classification belongs in the answer.

> A Large warehouse runs a three-cluster multi-cluster configuration in Maximized mode for eight hours a day.

Roughly how many credits does it consume per day?

A 8 credits

B 64 credits

C 192 credits

D 24 credits

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Roughly how many credits does it consume per day?

A 8 credits.

The hourly rate of a single Large cluster. Ignores both the cluster count and the hours.

B 64 credits.

8 times 8 hours. Correct for one cluster, and Maximized runs all three.

C 192 credits.

8 credits per hour, times 3 clusters, times 8 hours. Maximized runs every cluster the whole time.

D 24 credits.

8 times 3 clusters, for one hour. Ignores the eight-hour day.

ON THE EXAM

Modules 11 and 17. Size times clusters times time. Maximized mode is what makes all three run continuously.

> Files must be loaded from an S3 bucket. Several analysts hold the CREATE STAGE privilege. Security requires that no analyst can see the cloud credentials, and that access can be rotated in one place.

What should be configured?

A. A named internal stage, with files copied in from S3 beforehand.

B. An external stage with credentials supplied inline in CREATE STAGE.

C. A Snowflake SECRET object referenced by the stage.

D. A storage integration created by an administrator, referenced by the external stage.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should be configured?

A Internal stage, copy the files in first.

Something must still read the bucket to copy them, needing the same credentials. It also duplicates storage.

B Inline credentials.

Exactly what the requirement forbids. Anyone reading the DDL or running SHOW STAGES could see them.

C A SECRET object.

Secrets serve API integrations and external access, notably Git. Cloud storage uses storage integrations.

D A storage integration.

Created once by an administrator, referenced by many stages, and credentials never appear in a stage definition.

ON THE EXAM

Modules 13 and 16. Four integration types, and picking the wrong one is the commonest error in this area.

> A bulk COPY of 3,000 files fails after twenty minutes with a numeric conversion error on one row. Nothing is loaded. The team wants the load to complete and to review rejected rows afterwards.

What should change?

A Set VALIDATION_MODE = RETURN_ALL_ERRORS on the nightly load.

B Set ON_ERROR = CONTINUE, then review COPY_HISTORY.

C Set FORCE = TRUE so the load ignores previously failed rows.

D Set PURGE = TRUE so failed files are removed and retried.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should change?

A VALIDATION_MODE = RETURN_ALL_ERRORS.

Loads no data at all. The table would never be populated, which is worse than the current state.

B ON_ERROR = CONTINUE, then COPY_HISTORY.

Loads every row that parses, skips the rest, and the rejections are reviewable. Exactly the stated requirement.

C FORCE = TRUE.

Governs load metadata and reloading. It has nothing to do with error handling.

D PURGE = TRUE.

Removes files after a successful load. It does not change what happens on error.

ON THE EXAM

Module 14. The default for a bulk COPY is ABORT_STATEMENT, which is why one bad row destroyed 3,000 files of work.

> Files arrive in an S3 bucket at irregular intervals and must be loaded within a minute or two. The team wants no scheduled job and no application changes.

What should be configured?

A. A task on a one-minute schedule running COPY INTO.

B. Snowpipe Streaming, writing rows directly from the source system.

C. Snowpipe with auto-ingest, using a notification integration.

D. Snowpipe with the REST API, called by the application after each upload.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should be configured?

A A task every minute.

A scheduled job, which the scenario rules out, and it burns credits on every empty run.

B Snowpipe Streaming.

Writes rows from an application. Files already exist here, and it would require application changes.

C Auto-ingest with a notification integration.

Cloud event notifications trigger the load as files land. No schedule, no application change, about a minute.

D Snowpipe REST API.

Meets the latency and requires the application to call it, which the scenario forbids.

ON THE EXAM

Module 15. Two constraints, no schedule and no application change, leave exactly one of Snowpipe's two trigger modes.

> A task graph has a root task on an hourly cron schedule and three child tasks chained with AFTER. All four were created successfully. Nothing has run for two days.

What is the most likely cause?

A Tasks are created suspended. The root task was never resumed.

B Child tasks require their own schedules, which were not set.

C The cron expression is missing a time zone, so it never matches.

D SUSPEND_TASK_AFTER_NUM_FAILURES suspended the graph after the first failure.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the most likely cause?

A Created suspended, never resumed.

Tasks are created in a suspended state and must be resumed. Nothing running at all is the signature.

B Child tasks need schedules.

The opposite is true. A child task cannot have a schedule; it uses AFTER.

C Missing time zone.

A cron expression without a time zone still runs, using the account default.

D Auto-suspended after failures.

Requires runs to have failed. Nothing has run at all, so there were no failures to count.

ON THE EXAM

Module 15. 'Created successfully' plus 'nothing has run' is the fingerprint. A failure would leave history; a suspended task leaves none.

> At 09:00 each day, sixty analysts run short dashboard queries against a Medium warehouse. Query Profile shows queries queuing for up to three minutes. No spilling occurs and pruning is good.

What should be done?

A Resize the warehouse to X-Large so each query finishes faster.

B Convert to a multi-cluster warehouse with the Standard scaling policy.

C Enable the Query Acceleration Service on the warehouse.

D Add a clustering key to the dashboard tables.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should be done?

A. Resize to X-Large.

Scaling up helps one slow query. These queries are short; they are waiting for a slot, not running slowly.

B. Multi-cluster with Standard policy.

Queuing means concurrency. Standard starts a cluster immediately when a query queues, which suits a short morning peak.

C. Query acceleration.

Accelerates large scans with selective filters. Short dashboard queries are not its eligible shape.

D. A clustering key.

The scenario states pruning is already good. Clustering would change nothing.

ON THE EXAM

Module 17. Queuing means scale out, not up. Economy would be the wrong policy here, since short queries rarely justify a cluster.

> A query joining a 2 TB fact table to a small dimension table takes ninety minutes on a Medium warehouse. Query Profile shows 400 GB spilled to local storage and 90 GB to remote storage, with partitions scanned at 7% of total.

What is the primary problem?

A Inefficient pruning. 7% is too low.

B An exploding join. The dimension table has duplicate keys.

C Concurrency. The warehouse needs more clusters.

D Insufficient memory. Scale up, then optimise the query.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the primary problem?

A Pruning at 7%.

Inverts the ratio. 7% of partitions scanned is excellent pruning; low is good.

B An exploding join.

No row counts are given. The signature of an exploding join is rows out far exceeding rows in.

C Concurrency.

No queued time is mentioned, and one query cannot use two clusters.

D Insufficient memory. Scale up, then optimise.

400 GB local and 90 GB remote spill is the textbook memory signature, and remote spill is the clearest scale-up signal.

ON THE EXAM

Module 19. The pruning figure is the deliberate distractor. It looks like a problem until you notice low means good.

> A VARIANT column named payload contains an array at payload:items. Some rows have an empty items array. A query using LATERAL FLATTEN returns fewer rows than expected, and rows with empty arrays are missing entirely.

What should change?

A Add OUTER => TRUE to the FLATTEN call.

B Add RECURSIVE => TRUE to expand all sub-elements.

C Set MODE => 'ARRAY' so empty arrays are handled.

D Replace LATERAL with TABLE(FLATTEN(...)).

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should change?

A OUTER => TRUE.

OUTER defaults to FALSE, which omits rows that cannot be expanded. TRUE emits one row with NULLs instead.

B RECURSIVE => TRUE.

Expands sub-elements at deeper levels. It does not affect rows whose array is empty.

C MODE => 'ARRAY'.

MODE defaults to BOTH, which already covers arrays. It restricts rather than enables.

D TABLE(FLATTEN(...)).

For single-level arrays the two forms give the same result. It would change nothing.

ON THE EXAM

Module 21. OUTER is effectively an outer join. With the default, a row whose array is empty vanishes from the results.

> A team wants a function that accepts a product id and returns the full price history for that product, one row per price change, so it can be joined into reporting queries.

What should they build?

A. A scalar UDF returning an ARRAY, flattened by each caller.

B. A stored procedure returning tabular data, called before each query.

C. A UDTF, which returns a set of rows per input.

D. A vectorized Python UDF, which returns batches of rows.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they build?

A Scalar UDF returning an ARRAY.

Works, and pushes a FLATTEN into every calling query. It is a UDTF written the long way round.

B Tabular stored procedure.

Can be called in a FROM clause, and still needs a CALL and cannot be joined per row like a table function.

C A UDTF.

A table function returns a set of rows per input and joins naturally with LATERAL. Exactly the requirement.

D A vectorized Python UDF.

Vectorization processes input in batches for speed. It still returns one value per row.

ON THE EXAM

Module 22. 'One row per price change, joined into queries' is the definition of a table function.

> An engineer drops a permanent table at 14:00 on an Enterprise account where DATA_RETENTION_TIME_IN_DAYS is set to 5. At 16:00 the same day they need it back, with all data intact.

What should they do?

A Contact Snowflake Support to recover it from Fail-safe.

B Recreate the table and reload from the source system.

C Clone the table AT(OFFSET => -7200) to restore it alongside.

D Run UNDROP TABLE, which restores the most recent version.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should they do?

A Fail-safe via Support.

Fail-safe applies only after Time Travel expires. Five days of retention covers this comfortably.

B Recreate and reload.

Unnecessary work when the table can be restored in one statement.

C CLONE AT(OFFSET).

You cannot clone a table that no longer exists. Cloning with Time Travel works on existing objects.

D UNDROP TABLE.

Restores a dropped table within the retention window, in one statement, with all data intact.

ON THE EXAM

Module 23. The table was dropped, not damaged. UNDROP is for dropped objects; Time Travel clauses are for existing ones.

> A provider wants to give a consumer access to a filtered subset of a table, plus a stream so the consumer can process changes incrementally, plus a scalar function that formats an identifier.

Which of these can be added to a share?

A All three, provided the provider owns them.

B The filtered subset as a secure view, and the function as a secure UDF. The stream cannot be shared.

C Only the table itself. Views and functions cannot be shared.

D The secure view and the stream. Functions cannot be shared.

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which of these can be added to a share?

A All three.

Streams cannot be shared at all, whoever owns them.

B Secure view and secure UDF; not the stream.

Secure views and secure UDFs are both shareable. Streams are on the not-shareable list, and consumers make their own.

C Only the table.

Too restrictive. Secure views, secure materialized views, secure UDFs, external and dynamic tables are all shareable.

D View and stream, not the function.

Inverts two of the three. Functions can be shared if secure; streams cannot be shared at all.

ON THE EXAM

Module 24. The documented workaround is to let the consumer create their own stream on the shared objects.

Answer key and domain map

Q	ANSWER	DOMAIN AND TOPIC
1-4	C, A, D, B	D1: metadata cache, editions, temporary tables, SQL API
5-6	A, D	D1: AI_FILTER, clustering for ranges
7-10	B, C, A, C	D2: SECURITYADMIN, policy precedence, tag-based masking, credit arithmetic
11-14	D, B, C, A	D3: storage integration, ON_ERROR, auto-ingest, tasks created suspended
15-18	B, D, A, C	D4: scale out, spilling, FLATTEN OUTER, UDTF
19-20	D, B	D5: UNDROP, what can be shared

ON THE EXAM

Five A, five B, five C, five D. If your wrong answers cluster in one row of this table, that is the domain to revisit.

What your score means

- **17 or more:** comfortable. Use practice exams 2 and 3 to confirm, and revisit module 26 the day before.
- **15 to 16:** on track. Read every explanation, including for the ones you got right.
- **12 to 14:** more revision needed. Find the domain your misses cluster in and rewatch it, not the whole course.
- **Below 12:** go back to the domain drills in modules 7, 12, 16, 22 and 25 before attempting exam 2.
- **A miss you cannot explain** matters more than the total. Read that explanation twice.

> ON THE EXAM
>
> Next: practice exam 2, twenty fresh questions at the same weighting. Leave a day between them if you can.